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Executive Summary

WhiteWall Studios is paying \$300--700+/year for Squarespace and using it as a brochure site. The same site can be hosted for free on modern platforms like Vercel or GitHub Pages, with better performance, full analytics, and the ability to add AI-powered features and automations that Squarespace cannot support at any price.

What you're paying for:

- 29 static pages with images and text
- A \$0 product-as-booking-form workaround
- Placeholder subscription plans
- One possibly-inactive signup form

What you'd gain by moving:

- \$280--720/year in savings
- Full analytics (session recordings, heatmaps)
- Custom automations (Zapier, Make, n8n)
- AI-powered features (Claude chatbot, smart routing)

What You're Currently Paying

Item	Monthly	Annual
Squarespace Core (annual billing)	\$23/mo	\$276/yr
Squarespace Core (monthly billing)	\$33/mo	\$396/yr
Custom domain (whitewallstudios.co)	Included yr 1	~\$20/yr
Acuity Scheduling (if separate)	\$20+/mo	\$240+/yr
Total (annual, no Acuity)		~\$296/yr
Total (annual, with Acuity)		~\$536/yr
Total (monthly, with Acuity)		~\$656/yr

Note on Acuity: No Acuity embed was found on the live site. If you're using Acuity standalone (sending booking links directly), it's billed separately from Squarespace and works with any platform. Leaving Squarespace doesn't affect Acuity.

Site Audit: What Squarespace Actually Does for You

HEAVILY USED

- Static pages (29 total): home, locations, studio sets, gear rentals, FAQs, contact
- Image hosting/CDN: all photos via Squarespace CDN
- Gallery: 36-image masonry grid with lightbox
- SSL + hosting: standard web hosting
- Mobile responsive layout

- placeholder content, appears unused
- One form: free trial signup (yoga, boxing, etc.)
- Facebook Pixel tracking
- reCAPTCHA on forms

LIGHTLY USED

- Commerce: only as a booking workaround (two \$0 products added to cart to initiate booking)
- Subscription products: three plans at \$40/\$70/\$100,

NOT USED AT ALL

- No Acuity Scheduling embeds or links
- No email marketing integration
- No blog
- No member areas
- No Google Analytics

- No chat widget

PLACEHOLDER / DEAD CONTENT

- Terms & Conditions: empty
- Privacy Policy: empty
- FAQs-1: duplicate with template questions
- Free Trial: fitness class form (likely template leftover)

Bottom line: You're paying for a CMS/hosting platform and using it as a brochure site. The only Squarespace-native feature in real use is the image gallery with lightbox, which is trivially replaced by a free JavaScript library.

Where to Host: Vercel, GitHub Pages, and Others

Your site is static HTML/CSS/JS. Hosting is effectively free on any modern platform. All deploy the same way: push code to GitHub, site updates automatically. No FTP, no manual uploads, no waiting for Squarespace to rebuild.

Platform	Free Tier	Best For	Deploy Method
Vercel	100GB bandwidth, unlimited deploys	Server-side features (API routes, AI)	Git push auto-deploys
GitHub Pages	100GB bandwidth, 10 builds/hr	Simplest setup, zero config	Git push auto-deploys
Cloudflare Pages	Unlimited bandwidth, 500 builds/mo	Fastest global CDN	Git push auto-deploys
Netlify	100GB bandwidth, 300 build min/mo	Built-in forms, easy setup	Git push auto-deploys

RECOMMENDATION: VERCEL

Vercel is free for this use case and provides the clearest upgrade path. If WhiteWall ever wants to add server-side features (AI chatbot, dynamic pricing, automated emails), Vercel supports them natively via serverless functions and API routes, without needing a separate server.

GitHub Pages is the simplest option if the goal is purely static hosting with zero complexity.

How deployment works: Your site lives in a GitHub repository. When you push a change (or Andrew pushes one for you), the hosting platform automatically builds and deploys the updated site. Typical deploy time: 10--30 seconds. No downtime during deploys.

Full Service Replacement Map

Every service Squarespace provides has a free or cheaper replacement:

Component	Solution	Cost	Notes
Hosting	Vercel / GitHub Pages	\$0/mo	Free at this scale
Domain	Cloudflare or Namecheap	~\$10/yr	At-cost, no markup
SSL	Included with any host	\$0	Automatic HTTPS
Image CDN	Cloudflare or Vercel	\$0	Edge-served images
Scheduling	Acuity (keep) or Cal.com	\$0--20/mo	Embed on site
Forms	Formspree or Vercel serverless	\$0/mo	Free tier sufficient
Gallery	GLightbox / PhotoSwipe	\$0	Lightweight JS libraries
Memberships	Stripe Checkout + Billing	Per-txn	No monthly platform fee
Facebook Pixel	Script tag	\$0	Copy-paste
reCAPTCHA	Script tag	\$0	Same setup as now
Analytics	PostHog (see below)	\$0	Far superior to Squarespace
Automations	Zapier / Make / n8n	\$0--20/mo	Not possible on Squarespace
AI Features	Claude API via Vercel	Pay-per-use	Not possible on Squarespace
Total		~\$10/yr	+ optional services

What You Unlock by Leaving Squarespace

Squarespace is a walled garden. On a standard web stack, you get access to the entire modern web ecosystem. Here are three categories of tools that become available:

ANALYTICS: POSTHOG (FREE, REPLACES SQUARESPACE ANALYTICS)

Squarespace gives you basic page views. PostHog gives you:

- Session recordings: watch exactly how visitors navigate. See where they hesitate, what they click, where they drop off before booking.
- Heatmaps: visual overlay of clicks and scroll depth on each page.
- Funnels: track the path from landing to booking. ``80% see the gallery, but only 10% click Book Now."
- A/B testing: test two page versions and measure which converts better.
- Feature flags: roll out changes to 10% of visitors, check data, then go to 100%.

Free tier: 1 million events/month, 5,000 session recordings/month. More than enough for WhiteWall's traffic. This level of analytics is not available on Squarespace at any price tier.

AUTOMATIONS: ZAPIER, MAKE, AND N8N

Connect your site events to anything. Examples relevant to WhiteWall:

- New booking → auto-send confirmation email with studio access codes, parking info, prep checklist
- New booking → add row to Google Sheets for revenue tracking per location
- Form submission → create a lead in your CRM (or a Google Sheet)
- New booking → send SMS reminder 24 hours before the session
- Membership signup → auto-add to a private email list
- Low booking week → auto-post Instagram story with availability

Zapier free tier: 100 tasks/month. Make.com: even more generous. n8n: fully free and self-hosted. On Squarespace, you're limited to their handful of built-in integrations. Off Squarespace, your site can talk to literally anything with an API.

AI-POWERED FEATURES (CLAUDE VIA VERCEL)

With Vercel, you can add server-side API routes that run AI models. This is where a modern stack truly separates from Squarespace:

- AI booking assistant: a chat widget that answers questions about studios, pricing, and availability, then walks visitors through booking. Powered by Claude, trained on your content.
- Smart inquiry routing: AI reads contact form submissions and auto-categorizes them (booking inquiry, gear rental, event inquiry, partnership pitch), then routes to the right person or sends an auto-reply.
- Auto-generated social captions: upload a gallery photo, AI writes an Instagram caption with hashtags matching your brand voice.
- Dynamic FAQ: instead of a static page, a conversational interface that answers any question about the studios.
- Personalized landing pages: returning visitors see content tailored to their location preference (Taylor's Mill vs. Powdersville) based on previous browsing.

Cost: Claude API is pay-per-use. A booking assistant handling 100 conversations/month costs roughly \$2--5/month in API fees. Compare that to a \$49/mo chatbot SaaS. None of this is possible on Squarespace -- you can't run server-side code, call APIs, or add custom logic.

Cost Comparison

	Squarespace (Current)	Keep Acuity	Switch to Cal.com
Hosting	\$276--468/yr	\$0	\$0
Scheduling	\$240+/yr	\$240/yr	\$0
Domain	~\$20/yr	~\$10/yr	~\$10/yr
Year 1 Total	\$536--728	~\$250	~\$10
5-Year Total	\$2,680--3,640	~\$1,250	~\$50
5-Year Savings	--	\$1,430--2,390	\$2,630--3,590

Scheduling & Booking

CURRENT STATE

The live site handles booking like this:

1. Customer clicks ``Book Now''
2. Adds a \$0.00 product to Squarespace cart
3. Checks out (giving contact info)
4. WWS follows up via email/text to schedule

Key point: Acuity is not tied to Squarespace. It's billed separately and works with any platform. If you leave Squarespace, embed Acuity on the new site -- zero disruption to your booking flow.

SCHEDULING OPTIONS COMPARED

Feature	Acuity (\$20+/mo)	Cal.com (Free)	Calendly (\$10/mo)
Unlimited bookings	Yes	Yes	Yes
Multiple event types	Yes	Yes	Paid only
Embed on any site	Yes	Yes	Yes
Google Calendar sync	Yes	Yes	Yes
Payment at booking	Yes	Yes (Stripe)	Yes (Stripe)
Confirmation emails	Yes	Yes	Yes
Works without Squarespace	Yes	Yes	Yes
Cost/year	~\$240+	\$0	~\$120

If You Want to Edit Pages Yourself

The one thing Squarespace does well is its visual editor. Here are the alternatives:

Option	How It Works	Cost
Decap CMS	Git-based CMS with visual editor in browser. Edits go to GitHub.	\$0
Tina CMS	Similar to Decap with live visual editing.	\$0 (free tier)
Notion as CMS	Write in Notion, site pulls content automatically.	\$0
Just ask Andrew	Text me, I push the change in 5 minutes.	\$0 + friendship

Migration Effort

WHAT WE ALREADY HAVE

- 4-page HTML mockup with the full design system built
- Design system sheets (letter + phone PDF) for reference
- Font files (Cormorant Garamond, Inter)
- Logo asset

WHAT NEEDS TO BE BUILT

Task	Effort	Notes
Convert remaining pages to static HTML	8--12 hrs	4 pages already done
Image hosting + photo migration	1--2 hrs	Download from Squarespace CDN
Gallery with lightbox	1--2 hrs	GLightbox or PhotoSwipe
FAQ accordion	30 min	Standard component
Cal.com setup (2 locations)	1--2 hrs	Event types + embed
Stripe subscriptions (if needed)	2--3 hrs	Products + checkout links
Contact form	30 min	Formspree or similar
Facebook Pixel	15 min	Script tag
DNS migration	30 min	Point domain to new host
Testing + polish	2--3 hrs	Cross-browser, mobile, links
Total	16--24 hrs	

MIGRATION STEPS

1. Finish remaining pages using the existing mockup as a template
2. Set up Vercel (or Cloudflare Pages) and connect the GitHub repo
3. Set up Cal.com with two location-specific booking types
4. If subscriptions are active, set up Stripe Billing
5. Migrate images from Squarespace CDN
6. Add Facebook Pixel, reCAPTCHA, forms
7. Test everything
8. Switch DNS (5-minute cutover, no downtime if prepped)

Risks & Considerations

- Editing without code: If Drew/Max frequently edit page content, they'll need a CMS (Decap, Tina) or someone to make HTML changes. Squarespace's visual editor is the one thing that's hard to replace for free.
- Email: You use Google Workspace (MX records), not Squarespace email. No email migration needed.
- SEO: Redirect old Squarespace URLs to new ones. Squarespace uses paths like /about-taylors-mill-location which we can keep or redirect.
- Domain transfer: whitewallstudios.co needs to be transferred from Squarespace. Standard process, ~10 minutes + up to 5 day transfer window.

Questions to Confirm Before Moving

1. Are the \$40/\$70/\$100 membership plans live and collecting payments, or still in setup?
2. Is the free trial fitness form actually being used by customers?
3. Do you use Acuity standalone (sending booking links via text/email)?
4. Who currently makes content edits on the Squarespace site, and how often?

Summary

Question	Answer
Can you leave Squarespace?	Yes, easily. The site is mostly static pages with images.
What Squarespace features do you depend on?	Hosting, image CDN, and a hacky \$0 product-as-booking-form. That's it.
How much would you save?	\$280--720/year, up to \$3,590 over 5 years.
What happens to Acuity?	Nothing. Keep it as-is and embed on the new site, or switch to Cal.com.
What's the migration effort?	~16--24 hours. We're ~25% done with the mockup already.
What do you lose?	Squarespace's visual page editor. Everything else is free or cheaper.
What do you gain?	PostHog analytics, Zapier automations, AI features, full control.